Prashanti Anderson

Curriculum Vitæ

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Education

2025–on **PhD in EECS**, Massachusetts Institute of Technology, Advisor: Prof. Samuel B. Hopkins

2023–2025 **Master of Science**, Massachusetts Institute of Technology, Advisor: Prof. Samuel B. Hopkins

Thesis: A Geometry-Aware Exponential Mechanism for Private Estimation

2019–2023 **BSc in Computer Science**, Carnegie Mellon University, Graduated with University and Department Honors

Publications

Entrywise Low-Rank Approximation and Matrix $p \to q$ Norms via Global Correlation Rounding. Prashanti Anderson, Ainesh Bakshi, Samuel B. Hopkins. Preprint.

Faster MAX-CUT on Bounded Threshold Rank Graphs. Prashanti Anderson, Samuel B. Hopkins, Amit Rajaraman, David Steurer. Preprint.

Dimension Reduction via Sum-of-Squares and Improved Clustering Algorithms for Non-Spherical Mixtures. Prashanti Anderson, Mitali Bafna, Rares Buhai, Pravesh Kothari, David Steurer. Preprint.

2026 Additive Approximation Schemes for Low-Dimensional Embeddings. Prashanti Anderson, Ainesh Bakshi, Samuel B. Hopkins. SODA 2026.

2025 Sample-Optimal Private Regression in Polynomial Time. Prashanti Anderson, Ainesh Bakshi, Mahbod Majid, Stefan Tiegel. STOC 2025.

Experience

2022–2022 **Jane Street**, Software Engineering Intern

Fixed performance issues in internal tooling and built a distributed system for processing logs.

2021–2021 **Google**, Software Engineering Intern

Researched tools and prototyped systems for moving ML inference onto mobile devices.

2020–2020 **Google**, STEP Intern

Developed visualizations for sentiment analysis in open text responses.

Awards

2025 **NSF GRFP Honorable Mention**.

2023 **Alan J. Perlis Undergraduate Student Teaching Award**, Awarded to a graduating senior from Carnegie Mellon University who has shown the highest degree of excellence and dedication as a teaching assistant.

2023 **Carnegie Mellon Women's Association Award Receipient**, Awarded to one graduating senior from each college.

2023 **Phi Beta Kappa**.

Teaching

2025–2025 **Massachusetts Institute of Technology**, Introduction to Algorithms Teaching Assistant

2022–2023 **Carnegie Mellon University**, Great Ideas in Theoretical Computer Science Head Teaching Assistant

2020–2022 **Carnegie Mellon University**, Great Ideas in Theoretical Computer Science Teaching Assistant

2020–2020 **Carnegie Mellon University**, Principles of Imperative Computation Teaching Assistant

Service

2025–on **Group Lunch Organizer**, Co-organized Prof. Samuel B. Hopkins group lunch for 7 people. Ordered food and organized group member talks.

2025–2025 **Undergraduate Reading Group Lead**, Organized a reading group on online convex optimization for undergraduates in Fall 2025.